

YEAR

1. Passage anchor

> “A present that I really liked was a fountain pen that my older sister gave me a few ****years**** ago.”

Passage meaning

****year**** = a period of twelve months, especially used to measure time

****年** ; 一年

Here:

> ****a few years ago****

= ****幾年前****

Practice

1. She gave me the pen a few ****years**** ago.

她在幾****年前****送了我那支筆。

2. I have kept it for several ****years****.

我已經保存那支筆好幾****年****了。

Core meanings of YEAR

2. year — period of twelve months

= a period of approximately twelve months

****年** ; 一年

Examples

1. I lived there for three ****years****.

我在那裡住了三****年****。

2. A lot can change in a ****year****.

—****年****之內可以發生很多變化。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. calendar year

= period from January 1 to December 31

曆年；日曆年

Examples

1. Sales increased during the last **calendar year**.
上一個**曆年**的銷售額有所增加。

2. The report covers the entire **calendar year**.
這份報告涵蓋整個**曆年**。

4. this year / last year / next year

These are high-frequency time expressions:

* **this year** = 今年

* **last year** = 去年

* **next year** = 明年

Examples

1. I started university **last year**.
我**去年**開始讀大學。

2. We are planning to travel **next year**.
我們打算**明年**去旅行。

Age

5. year — unit used to express age

= unit for stating how old someone or something is

歲；年

Examples

1. She is twenty **years old**.
她二十**歲**。

2. The building is over a hundred ****years old****.

這棟建築已有一百多****年歷史****。

6. years old

= having existed or lived for a stated number of years

****.....歲；有.....年歷史****

Examples

1. The child is five ****years old****.

那個孩子五****歲****。

2. This tree is more than two hundred ****years old****.

這棵樹已有兩百多****年樹齡****。

School / university level

7. year — stage in a school or university course

= one of the annual levels of study in a school, college, or university

****年級；學年階段****

Examples

1. She is in her first ****year**** at university.

她正在讀大學一****年級****。

2. Students in the final ****year**** have to complete a project.

****最後一年級****的學生必須完成一個專案。

This is a major distinct sense.

8. first-year / second-year / final-year student

= student identified by year of study

****一年級 / 二年級 / 畢業年級學生****

Examples

1. He is a **first-year student**.

他是一名**一年級學生**。

2. She is a **final-year student**.

她是**畢業年級學生**。

Academic year

9. academic year

= period during which a school or university conducts teaching, usually less than a full calendar year

學年

Examples

1. The new **academic year** starts in September.

新**學年**在九月開始。

2. Tuition is paid for each **academic year**.

學費按每個**學年**繳交。

10. school year

= period of the year during which students attend school

學年；**學期年度**

Examples

1. The **school year** ends in June.

學年在六月結束。

2. She moved schools in the middle of the **school year**.

她在**學年**中途轉校。

Financial / business period

11. financial year

= twelve-month period used for accounting and financial reporting

****財政年度；會計年度****

Examples

1. The company reported strong results for the ****financial year****.
公司公布本****財政年度****業績強勁。
2. Spending must be recorded within the current ****financial year****.
支出必須記錄在本****財政年度****內。

12. fiscal year

= accounting year used by a government, company, or organization

****財政年度；會計年度****

Examples

1. The budget applies to the next ****fiscal year****.
這份預算適用於下一個****財政年度****。
2. Revenue rose during the last ****fiscal year****.
上一****財政年度****的收入有所上升。

Especially common in American English and business/government contexts.

Length / duration

13. year-long

= lasting for a whole year

****為期一年的；持續一整年的****

Examples

1. She completed a ****year-long course****.
她完成了一個****為期一年的課程****。
2. The museum held a ****year-long exhibition****.
博物館舉辦了一場****持續一整年的展覽****。

14. year-round

= happening or available throughout the entire year

****全年；全年的****

Examples

1. The pool is open ****year-round****.

游泳池****全年開放****。

2. The island has warm weather ****year-round****.

那座島****全年**天氣都很暖**。

A particular period in history

15. year — particular numbered year

= a specific calendar period identified by a number

****某一年；年份****

Examples

1. 1997 was an important ****year**** in Hong Kong history.

1997 年是香港歷史上重要的****一年****。

2. What ****year**** were you born?

你是哪一****年****出生的？

16. in the year...

= in a specified calendar year

****在.....年****

Examples

1. The company was founded ****in the year 2000****.

公司成立於 ****2000 年****。

2. The bridge opened ****in the year 2012****.

這座橋於 ****2012 年****啟用。

Approximate / repeated time

17. years — a long time

Plural ****years**** can mean a long period of time rather than emphasizing the exact number.

****多年；很久****

Examples

1. I haven't seen her in ****years****.

我已經****很多年 / 很久****沒見她了。

2. It took ****years**** to complete the research.

那項研究花了****多年****才完成。

18. for years

= for a long period measured in years

****多年來；好幾年****

Examples

1. She worked there ****for years****.

她在那裡工作了****很多年****。

2. I had wanted to visit Japan ****for years****.

我****多年來****一直想去日本。

19. years ago

= a number of years before now

****幾年前；多年前****

Examples

1. We met ****years ago****.

我們在****多年前****認識。

2. That happened many ****years ago****.

那件事發生在****很多年前****。

This is the passage pattern.

Every / each year

20. every year

= once or repeatedly during each year

每年

Examples

1. We visit our relatives **every year**.

我們**每年**都會探望親戚。

2. The festival takes place **every year**.

這個節慶**每年**舉行。

21. year by year

= gradually as each year passes

逐年；一年一年地

Examples

1. The town has grown **year by year**.

這座城鎮**逐年**發展。

2. Her confidence improved **year by year**.

她的自信**一年一年地**增強。

22. year after year

= repeatedly for many consecutive years

年復一年；連年

Examples

1. They returned to the same village **year after year**.

他們**年復一年**回到同一個村莊。

2. The team performed well **year after year**.

那支球隊**連年**表現出色。

Comparison between years

23. year on year

= compared with the same period in the previous year

按年；同比

Common in business, economics, and statistics.

Examples

1. Sales rose 10% **year on year**.

銷售額**按年**上升了 10%。

2. Inflation fell **year on year**.

通脹率**同比**下降。

24. year-over-year

= compared with the corresponding period one year earlier

按年；同比

Especially American/business usage.

Examples

1. Revenue increased 8% **year-over-year**.

收入**按年**上升 8%。

2. The company reported strong **year-over-year growth**.

公司錄得強勁的**按年增長**。

New Year

25. New Year

= beginning of a new calendar year, often referring to the holiday period

****新年****

Examples

1. We celebrated ****New Year**** with friends.

我們和朋友一起慶祝****新年****。

2. Happy ****New Year****!

****新年快樂！****

Capitalized when referring to the holiday/event.

26. New Year's Eve

= evening of December 31

****除夕；跨年夜****

Examples

1. We watched fireworks on ****New Year's Eve****.

我們在****跨年夜****看煙花。

2. The city is crowded on ****New Year's Eve****.

城市在****除夕 / 跨年夜****很擁擠。

27. New Year's Day

= January 1

****元旦；新年第一天****

Examples

1. The office is closed on ****New Year's Day****.

辦公室在****元旦****休息。

2. We went hiking on ****New Year's Day****.

我們在****元旦****去遠足。

Calendar / age compounds

28. leap year

= year with an extra day, February 29

****閏年****

Examples

1. 2024 was a ****leap year****.

2024 年是****閏年****。

2. A ****leap year**** normally has 366 days.

****閏年****通常有 366 天。

29. light-year

= unit of distance equal to the distance light travels in one year

****光年****

Important: despite the word ****year****, this measures ****distance****, not time.

Examples

1. The star is several ****light-years**** away.

那顆恆星距離我們幾個****光年****。

2. A ****light-year**** is a unit of distance.

****光年****是距離單位。

Age-group compounds

30. year-old

Used after a number before a noun:

> a ten-****year-old**** child

= ****十歲的孩子****

Examples

1. She has a five-****year-old**** son.

她有一個**五歲的**兒子。

2. It is a hundred-**year-old** building.

那是一棟**有一百年歷史的**建築。

Grammar note:

> **ten years old**

> but

> a **ten-year-old** child

Idioms and fixed expressions

31. all year round

= throughout the whole year

全年；一年到頭

Examples

1. The shop is open **all year round**.

這家店**全年營業**。

2. It is warm there **all year round**.

那裡**一年到頭**都很暖。

32. donkey's years

British informal:

= a very long time

很久很久；好多年

Examples

1. I haven't seen him for **donkey's years**.

我已經**好多年**沒見他了。

2. That shop has been there for **donkey's years**.

那家店已經在那裡開了**很久很久**。

Lower priority but established BrE idiom.

33. not in a million years

= absolutely never; under no imaginable circumstances

絕對不會；想都別想

Examples

1. I would **not in a million years** agree to that.
我**絕對不可能**答應那件事。
2. She never imagined **in a million years** that she would win.
她**做夢也沒想到**自己會贏。

34. put years on someone

= make someone look or feel older, often because of stress or hardship

使某人顯老；讓某人老了很多

Examples

1. The stress **put years on him**.
壓力讓他看起來**老了很多**。
2. Months of worry seemed to **put years on her**.
幾個月的擔憂讓她彷彿**老了好幾歲**。

35. take years off someone

= make someone look younger

使某人顯得年輕很多

Examples

1. The new haircut **took years off her**.
新髮型讓她看起來**年輕了好幾歲**。
2. A good rest seemed to **take years off him**.
充分休息讓他看起來**年輕不少**。

Related forms

36. yearly — adjective

= happening once every year or relating to a year

****每年的；一年一次的****

Examples

1. We have a ****yearly meeting****.

我們有****每年一次的會議****。

2. The company publishes a ****yearly report****.

公司發布****年度報告****。

37. yearly — adverb

= once every year

****每年****

Examples

1. The fee is paid ****yearly****.

費用****每年****支付一次。

2. The system is reviewed ****yearly****.

系統****每年****檢討一次。

38. annual

Near-synonym rather than direct morphological derivative:

= happening once every year

****每年的；年度的****

Compare:

> yearly report

> annual report

Both can mean **年度報告**, though **annual** is often more formal.

Key contrasts

39. year vs age

year

= unit used to measure time

年

age

= how long a person or thing has existed

年齡 ; 年代

Compare:

> She is twenty **years** old.

> 她二十歲。

> What is her **age**?

> 她幾歲？

40. year vs calendar year

year

= any twelve-month period, depending on context

calendar year

= specifically January 1 through December 31

41. calendar year vs academic year

calendar year

= January–December

曆年

academic year

= teaching period of a school/university

學年

They often begin and end on different dates.

42. financial year vs calendar year

****financial year****

= accounting/reporting period

****財政 / 會計年度****

****calendar year****

= January–December

A financial year does not necessarily begin in January.

43. year vs grade

****year****

in BrE and many education systems can describe stage of study:

> first year

****grade****

is especially common in American school systems:

> fifth grade

Both may correspond broadly to ****年級****, but the systems are not always directly equivalent.

44. year vs annum

****annum****

= Latin-derived formal word meaning year, mainly in expressions like:

> per annum

****每年 ; 每年計****

Example:

> 5% per annum

> 年利率 5%

****year**** is the ordinary everyday word.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****year**** is:

****a standard unit for measuring a long period of time****

From this develop:

Time duration

a year

→ ****一年****

Past reference

years ago

→ ****幾年前 / 多年前****

Age

twenty years old

→ ****二十歲****

Education

first year

→ ****一年級 / 第一學年****

School calendar

academic year

→ ****學年****

Finance

financial year

→ ****財政年度****

Repetition

every year

→ **每年**

Gradual change

year by year

→ **逐年**

Repeated continuity

year after year

→ **年復一年**

Business comparison

year on year

→ **按年 / 同比**

Distance compound

light-year

→ **光年**

The passage uses the basic time-duration sense:

> **a few years ago**

> → **幾年前**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
year — twelve-month period	用來計算時間的大約十二個月期間；年 / 一年
calendar year	從 1 月 1 日至 12 月 31 日的曆年
this/last/next year	今年 / 去年 / 明年
year — age	用來表示人或物存在多久的年數；歲 / 年
years old	表示某人幾歲或某物已有多少年歷史
year — education level	學校或大學課程中的某一年度階段；年級 / 學年
academic year	學校或大學進行教學的一個學年
school year	學校一年中的上課期間；學年
financial/fiscal year	公司、政府等用於財務及會計的年度期間
year-long	持續整整一年的
year-round	全年持續或全年都可使用的
year — specific date period	以數字辨識的某一特定年份
years — long time	多年；很長一段時間

for years	持續多年 / 很久	
years ago	在現在之前若干年；幾年前 / 多年前	
every year	每年	
year by year	隨著每一年逐漸改變；逐年	
year after year	連續多年重複發生；年復一年	
year on year / year-over-year	與上一年同期比較；按年 / 同比	
New Year	新曆年開始時的新年 / 新年節慶	
leap year	比一般年份多一天的閏年	
light-year	光一年行進的距離；光年，屬距離單位	
year-old	用於名詞前表示「.....歲的 / 有.....年歷史的」	
all year round	全年；一年到頭	
donkey's years	英式非正式：非常久、好多年	
not in a million years	絕對不會；怎樣也不可能	
put years on someone	使某人看起來或感覺老了很多	
take years off someone	使某人看起來年輕很多	
yearly	每年的；一年一次地	

Passage recap

> “...my older sister gave me [the pen] a few ****years ago****.”

Here:

****year**** = ****a period of twelve months used to measure time****

and:

> ****a few years ago****

> = ****幾年前****

Natural contextual translation:

****我姐姐幾年前送給我的一支鋼筆。 ****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****year****

= ****a period of twelve months used as a unit of time****

****年；一年****

The most important polysemy contrast is:

> three ****years****

> → 三年 (時間)

> twenty ****years old****

> → 二十歲 (年齡)

> first ****year**** at university

> → 大學一年級 / 第一學年 (教育階段)

> financial ****year****

> → 財政年度

In the passage, ****years**** simply measures elapsed time between receiving the gift and the present.